

ASMIT DATTA

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Creative Technologist Graduate Assistant

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First, I would like to talk about how I approach problems, how I get better at them, and how I work in a team. I accept it when I fall short of understanding something, and I give my best to understand it from people better than me. I have a lot of respect for anyone I can learn from, and I am not ashamed to ask the same question twice if that is what it takes. It works the other way too. When someone is stuck on something I have already worked out, I will sit with them rather than hand over the answer, and I come out of those understanding it better than when I went in. Knowledge seems to be one of the few things that grows when you share it. I think about problems in systems, and I approach them that way. I think that is also what makes me useful explaining something to someone else - I still remember what it is like to not understand it yet.

I would encourage you to visit my portfolio at www.asmit.space.

After reading the requirements, I would like to give a few examples of the work I have done that show I am ready for this role. Across my internships the job has mostly been taking an idea, turning it into a workflow and a user journey, and then building it. At MyYogaTeacher I was handed a feature as a high-level idea and asked to produce the initial design - the diagrams, wireframes and user journeys. Those went out to the development team I was also part of, so I built against my own drawings. My portfolio works the same way. It is a room I modelled in Blender and put in the browser with Three.js, where you walk up to the desk, click the machine, and every project opens as its own artifact. At WatchDNA I set up the backend from scratch on Node.js - the schema, the REST endpoints, JWT authentication with role-based access and the security middleware - and built the admin console over it. The companion React Native app reused the same auth and data layers. Pash is a media pipeline. Uploads land in S3, jobs queue through SQS so a worker dying does not lose the job, and Demucs splits each track on a remote CUDA worker. The MyYogaTeacher client streams biometric data with offline-first sync and time-series deduplication, so nothing is lost when the network drops. Lead Engine's dashboard is a live pipeline graph where a failed scout shows up the moment it fails, and on everything I have shipped I hook up alerts for when something goes wrong, so it gets debugged and fixed right away. I can work between five and fifteen hours a week as the work requires, and with no classes on Monday or Thursday I can figure out a flexible schedule around the in-person meetings.